

Ahmad Abdul-Jawad

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CHIEF TECHNOLOGY OFFICER / HEAD OF ENGINEERING

CAIRO — RIYADH · 12+ YEARS BUILDING · 8+ LEADING



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• SEE THE LIVE INTERACTIVE EDITION ↗

A technologist who has owned every layer of the job. **12+ years** building and **8+ leading** — seven of them running the iOS organisation behind a POS platform trusted by **20k+ restaurants and cafés**. I set technology strategy, own architecture and the roadmap, build the standards an engineering team runs on, and answer for delivery. And I have carried the **whole technical scope of a founding CTO alone**: a production ride-hailing platform I am architecting and building solo — native iOS & Android clients, a hardened NestJS / PostgreSQL / Redis backend, and a Next.js operations console — so no layer of the stack is a black box to me when I am deciding for a company.

12+ YEARS IN ENGINEERING	8+ YEARS LEADING ENGINEERING TEAMS	35M+ USERS REACHED ACROSS SHIPPED APPS	20k+ BUSINESSES SERVED BY THE POS I LED
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§ 01 The Technology Office

01 — TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY	02 — ORGANISATION & TALENT
Choose the bets, own the consequences Stack, architecture, and roadmap as a single decision: platform choices, module boundaries, data models, security posture — and the migration plans that keep a codebase current without stalling the business . At Marn that meant moving a seven-year-old production POS to SwiftUI, Combine and async/await while features kept shipping.	An engineering function, not a headcount Seven years building and leading a 5+ engineer team — onboarding, mentoring, career conversations, and a review culture where quality is the default rather than a phase. The standards I set held the product at a 99.8-99.9% crash-free rate under real enterprise load.
03 — DELIVERY & OPERATIONS	04 — WHOLE-STACK OWNERSHIP
Commitments the company can plan around CI/CD and release automation built from nothing (60% faster deployments), test suites that gate merges, explicit performance and crash budgets (40% faster load times), and planning with product and design in commitments the team can actually keep.	No layer is someone else's problem iOS & Android clients, NestJS/PostgreSQL/Redis backends, Next.js operations consoles. I am building and running all four layers of a production platform solo — trip state machine, scored dispatch, double-entry ledger, realtime sockets, 2,800+ tests — so I can cost a technical decision before the company pays for it.

§ 02 Professional Experience

Aug 2019 — Aug 2026 RIYADH, KSA	iOS Team Lead — 7 years leading the iOS org Marn — Jahez Group ↗ — Led a 5+ engineer iOS team for seven years — onboarding, mentoring, career growth, and the review culture behind an enterprise POS used by 20k+ restaurants and cafés. — Owned the technical roadmap and architecture : an offline-first CoreData core with cloud sync; built so a venue keeps trading when the network does not. — Set the engineering standards — module boundaries, code review, automated testing — that held the app at a 99.8-99.9% crash-free rate in production. — Drove the multi-year migration to SwiftUI, Combine and async/await without pausing feature delivery, and made the case for it to product leadership. — Built CI/CD and the release process from scratch , cutting deployment time 60% and shortening every engineer's feedback loop. — Ran the performance programme (40% faster load times) and designed the table-management, order-processing and inventory systems at the heart of the product. — Partnered with product, design and backend leadership on scope, estimates and delivery commitments the team could keep.
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Mar 2026 — Present CURRENT INDEPENDENT	Founding Platform Architect — iOS · Android · Backend · Web Ride-Hailing Platform · Independent Project Took the full technical scope of a founding CTO and carried it alone: chose the stack, set the standards, and have been building a production ride-hailing platform — a hardened backend and a real-time ops console in production , with two native iOS/SwiftUI apps (Rider & Driver) and the Android driver app in active development. Every layer from data model to release, governed by explicit rules: idempotent mutations, double-entry accounting, acyclic module boundaries, and a CI test suite that gates the merge.
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Backend APIs NestJS · TypeScript · Mar '26 → now	Modular monolith, 22 domains — trip state machine, scored dispatch over a Redis geo index, double-entry ledger , realtime rider/driver/admin sockets , JWT + phone-OTP, idempotency & audit log · ~300 endpoints over 47 controllers, 2,800+ tests , Swagger docs.
Admin Console Next.js 14 · Jun '26 → now	Bespoke 30-screen ops surface — live MapLibre trips map, dispatch/SOS live boards, KYC onboarding review, finance reconciliation, refunds/payouts, cash control, map zone editor , feature flags, audit log, Google SSO .
iOS Apps · Rider & Driver SwiftUI · Jul '26 → now	Two native SwiftUI apps on a shared BuraqCore Swift package (domain · networking · design system, pinned remotely) — live GPS trip lifecycle , Socket.IO feeds with fresh-token receipt, in-app chat, payments, Live Activities, driver earnings & turn-by-turn navigation · ~150 SwiftUI views, 430+ tests .
Android App · Driver Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Sep '26 → now	Native Kotlin / Compose port of the driver app against the same API contract — modularised (core · networking · design system · domain) with the design-system and CI bar in place; product features porting now.
One backend · one contract · three clients in flight — plus growth loops (promotions, referrals, loyalty tiers, wallet), driver safety/SOS, and scheduled reconciliation jobs. The exercise a technical leader needs periodically: own every trade-off yourself, then know exactly what you are asking of a team.	

Dec 2025 — Jun 2026 VOLUNTEER	Senior iOS Engineer HaramBlur ↗ · Voluntary Charity Project — Designed an architecture integrating on-device machine learning for real-time content analysis. — Built a seamless communication layer between native iOS and web-based content. — Implemented efficient image processing with region-based and full-image blur effects. — Created a real-time video monitoring system for continuous content filtering. — Developed smart banner blocking and optimised memory management throughout.
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Mar 2018 — May 2019 RIYADH, KSA	iOS Team Lead Ego — The Ride Hailing App ↗ — Led iOS delivery for a complete ride-hailing ecosystem (rider, driver, watchOS) serving 15M+ users in Saudi Arabia. — Implemented real-time GPS tracking and navigation with MapKit and optimised route algorithms. — Integrated Apple Pay, HyperPay, and push-notification infrastructure. — Created seamless iPhone — Apple Watch handoff for continuous ride tracking. — Built the driver rating system and real-time fare calculation engine.
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Sep 2016 — Mar 2018 KSA	Senior iOS Engineer HungerStation — DeliveryHero Group ↗ — Contributed to a major food-delivery platform serving 20M+ users. — Optimised app performance for high-volume transaction processing. — Implemented real-time order tracking and delivery optimisation. — Collaborated with backend teams on API design and integration.
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May 2016 — Aug 2016	iOS Developer ALNapedh ↗ — Developed food-ordering apps with Firebase integration and real-time features. — Implemented Speedrely payments and live-chat functionality. — Built responsive UI with Auto Layout across multiple device sizes.
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Jul 2015 — Sep 2015	iOS & Apple Watch Developer Nile Design Co. ↗ — Early adopter of Apple Watch development (watchOS 1-2). — Built a foundation in iOS and watchOS app development. — Adopted SwiftUI from WWDC 2019 onward.
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May 2014 — May 2015	iOS Developer UK Pro. Solutions Ltd. ↗ — Foundation iOS experience in Objective-C and early Swift. — Built social networks and e-commerce platforms. — Learned core iOS principles and App Store deployment.
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§ 03 Selected Projects

01 — FULL-STACK	02 — ENTERPRISE
Ride-Hailing Platform (built from scratch · since Mar 2026) SwiftUI · Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · NestJS · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Redis · Socket.IO · Next.js End-to-end ride-hailing platform architected solo: a hardened NestJS backend (trip state machine, scored dispatch, double-entry ledger, realtime sockets, 2,800+ tests) and a real-time Next.js operations console in production , with three native clients (Rider & Driver on iOS/SwiftUI, Driver on Android/Kotlin-Compose) in active development. ★ Four Platforms · Solo Ownership · Production Security	Marn — iPad POS SwiftUI · CoreData · CloudKit · Real-time Sync Enterprise point-of-sale serving 20k+ restaurants and cafés across Saudi Arabia. Offline-first architecture, complex table management, real-time order processing — the product my iOS team owned for seven years . ★ 4.8 / 5 — 2,437 ratings
03 — MOBILITY	04 — DELIVERY
Ego — Ride Hailing MapKit · Core Location · Apple Pay · Push · watchOS Complete ride-hailing ecosystem: rider app, driver app, and Apple Watch companion. Real-time GPS, Apple Pay, and cross-device experiences for 15M+ users. ★ 4.7 / 5 — 211.8k+ ratings	HungerStation UIKit · Firebase · Real-time APIs · Perf Optimization Major food-delivery platform serving 20M+ users across Saudi Arabia and Bahrain. Focused on performance and real-time order tracking. ★ 4.5 / 5 — 1.9M+ ratings
05 — AI / PRIVACY	06 — COMMUNITY
HaramBlur — Privacy Browser SwiftUI · CoreML · WKWebView · CoreImage · Vision Privacy-focused iOS browser with real-time, AI-powered content detection and filtering. On-device ML, smart blur effects, and live video monitoring. ★ AI-Powered Privacy Browser	Daleelo MapKit · Core Location · Social SDKs · Community Muslim community app for users across the US — prayer times, mosque finder, and community features with enhanced location and social integration. ★ 4.5 / 5 — 1,287 ratings

§ 04 Stack & Craft

ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP	ORG
Team Leadership	Technical Direction
Architecture Governance	Technical Roadmap
Mentoring & Career Growth	Onboarding
Code Review Culture	Estimation & Planning
Cross-functional Partnership	Quality & Crash Budgets
Release Management	Agile / Scrum
IOS — 2025	CORE
Swift 6.0	SwiftUI
UIKit	Combine
async/await	
SwiftData	iOS 18+
ANDROID — 2025	NATIVE
Kotlin	Jetpack Compose
Coroutines	Flow
MVVM	
ARCHITECTURE	PATTERNS
MVVM	VIPER
Clean Architecture	Coordinator
TDD	
APPLE ECOSYSTEM	PLATFORMS
watchOS	tvOS
macOS	WidgetKit
Live Activities	App Intents
MODERN FEATURES	INTELLIGENCE
Core ML	Vision
ARKit	Dynamic Island
App Tracking	
BACKEND & APIS	FULL-STACK
NestJS	TypeScript
PostgreSQL	TypeORM
Redis	
JWT/OTP Auth	REST
GraphQL	Firebase
CloudKit	
WebSockets	Swagger/OpenAPI
TOOLING & AI	WORKFLOW
Xcode 15+	Fastlane
TestFlight	Instruments
Git	Copilot
Cursor	

§ 05 Portfolio Index

FOOD & GAMING	E-COMMERCE
HungerStation — delivery	iBss
Punters — racing tips	Exlusive Luxe
	Scratch
TRANSPORTATION	RELIGIOUS & EDU
Ego — Rider	Afasy
Ego — Driver	ArabNileGroup
Ego — Watch app	
ENTERPRISE	UTILITY & TOOLS
Marn POS	Unlocking Smart
Medical Guide	Insta
	iContacts
	🚀 First iOS app
SOCIAL & COMMUNITY	AI & ML
Daleelo	HaramBlur — CoreML
NU-inc	RecognizeMe
VeeU	🚀 Grad project — OpenCV
WATCHOS	WEB
Ego Watch	FaceDemo
TaQs Weather	Web Pages
TweetMe	

§ 06 Record

EDUCATION

ISTQB Foundation Level
Egyptian Software Testing Qualification Board

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Professional

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Honours

01

Led an iOS engineering team for 7 consecutive years on a POS platform serving 20k+ restaurants and cafés — through the product's growth from launch scale to enterprise.

§ 07 Honours

01	Led an iOS engineering team for 7 consecutive years on a POS platform serving 20k+ restaurants and cafés — through the product's growth from launch scale to enterprise.
02	Held a 99.8-99.9% crash-free rate and cut deployment time 60% by building the standards, tests and CI/CD the team ran on.
03	Architecting a full-stack ride-hailing platform solo — NestJS/PostgreSQL backend and Next.js ops console in production, three native clients (two iOS, one Android) in development, with idempotent APIs and double-entry accounting.
04	Built a food-delivery platform serving 20M+ users across Saudi Arabia and Bahrain, and a ride-hailing ecosystem serving 15M+ users in Saudi Arabia.
05	10+ apps published on the App Store, used by millions across MENA.
06	30+ projects delivered across a 12-year career.
07	Early Swift adopter (WWDC 2014) and early SwiftUI adopter (WWDC 2019) — a habit of betting on the right platform shift early.